

Jothi Tutor Development Standards

MENTOR OBSERVATION STANDARD

The standard for observing, coaching, and evidencing tutor development within the Johti Tutor Academy

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Intended Audience	Mentors conducting lesson observations within the Johti Tutor Academy
Related Documents	JTD01 v2.0, JTD02 v2.0, JTD03 v2.0, JTD05, JTD06 v2.0, JF03 v2.0, JTS01 v2.0

1. Purpose

This document defines the standard for mentor observation within the Johti Tutor Academy. It tells mentors what to observe, how to structure their judgement, and what the JTD04 form requires at each stage of the residency.

Observation is not lesson watching. It is structured evidence collection that drives coaching decisions, informs competency sign-off, and contributes to certification. A poorly conducted observation wastes the mentor's time, gives the tutor no useful development signal, and weakens the evidence base for progression decisions.

This standard exists so that observation is consistent, specific, and operationally useful — across all mentors and across all stages of the residency.

2. What Observation Is For

Mentor observation serves three distinct purposes. Mentors should be clear which purpose dominates on any given observation, because this shapes the form and the feedback.

Purpose	When It Applies	Primary Output
Developmental	During Co-Teaching and Lead Teaching stages. The tutor is still learning. The priority is coaching, not judging.	One clear improvement target — specific enough to act on in the next lesson.

Purpose	When It Applies	Primary Output
Evidence Collection	During Lead Teaching and Independent Teaching. Evidence is being built toward competency sign-off.	A JTD04 record documenting specific teaching behaviour against named competency codes.
Calibration	A second mentor observes to check whether the primary mentor's assessments are consistent with an independent view.	Calibration note on the JTD04 form. Agreed or divergent view documented.

A single observation can serve more than one purpose — but the mentor should be explicit about which is primary, because it determines how the feedback is framed and how the form is completed.

3. When to Observe

- Co-Teaching: observe every session where the tutor leads a section. Minimum 2 formal JTD04 records required.
- Lead Teaching: observe all four structured sessions (30, 45, 60, 60 minutes). All four require a JTD04 record.
- Independent Teaching: observe minimum 2 of the 6-week cycle lessons. At least 1 must be a calibration observation by a second mentor.
- Certification Runway: observe any final targeted sessions agreed in the Final Evidence Plan.

Do not observe only the first lesson of a stage and assume the pattern is clear. A single lesson tells you about that lesson. A pattern across multiple lessons tells you about the tutor.

4. Observing Through the 4T Teaching Engine

The 4T Teaching Engine — Teach, Test, Track, Transform — is the observation frame for every Johti lesson. Mentors should use it to structure what they notice and what they record.

Phase	What the Tutor Should Be Doing	Strong Evidence	Weak Practice
Teach	Explaining the concept clearly, step by step, with reasoning visible on the board.	Student can follow the logic without guessing. Each step connects to the previous one.	Explanation is fluent but unclear. Steps are skipped. Board shows answers, not reasoning.
Test	Asking questions that reveal how the student is thinking — not just whether they got the answer right.	Questions expose reasoning. Tutor uses the answer to decide what to do next.	'Do you understand?' is the main check. Student says yes and tutor moves on.
Track	Watching how the student is working — hesitation, errors, guessing,	Tutor notices a specific error pattern or hesitation point and responds to it.	Tutor looks at final answers only. Misses hesitation that preceded a lucky correct answer.

Phase	What the Tutor Should Be Doing	Strong Evidence	Weak Practice
	misapplication of a method.		
Transform	Addressing misunderstanding by identifying the source of error and rebuilding the reasoning — not just correcting the answer.	Student understands why the correction is correct, not just that it is correct.	Tutor gives the right answer. Student writes it down. Misconception remains in place.

5. Competency Focus by Stage

Every JTD04 record must name the primary competency being observed. Mentors should agree with the tutor in advance which competency will be the focus of the observation. This gives the tutor a clear developmental target and ensures the observation generates usable sign-off evidence.

Stage	Competency Level	Notes
Co-Teaching	JCT1 only	Focus on C1 — Explaining with Clarity and Structure, C2 — Using Diagnostic Questioning, C3 — Actively Checking Understanding, F2 — Professional Reliability and Readiness, F3 — Engaging Productively with Mentor Feedback, F4 — Maintaining Ethical and Professional Standards. JCT2 and JCT3 should not be assessed at this stage.
Lead Teaching	JCT1 consolidating, JCT2 emerging	By session 3, JCT1 evidence should be consistent enough to begin sign-off conversations. JCT2 competencies (A1, A2, B1, B2, C4, C5, D1, E1, E2, F1) become the observation focus from session 2 onward.
Independent Teaching	JCT2 consolidating, JCT3 emerging	JCT2 competencies should be moving toward sign-off. JCT3 competencies (A3, B3, D2, D3, D4) should begin to appear. The 6-week cycle provides the evidence base for both.

6. What Strong Observation Looks Like

A strong observation produces a record that can stand alone. A second mentor reading the JTD04 form should understand what happened, what the mentor judged, and why — without asking questions.

Identify one clear strength

Name a specific teaching behaviour that was strong and say why. Not 'good lesson' or 'students engaged well'. For example: 'When the student gave an incorrect answer, the tutor identified the specific sign error, rewrote the step, and asked the student to explain why the corrected version worked — C4 Guided Practice, strong.'

Identify one improvement priority

Name one specific thing the tutor should do differently in the next lesson. Not 'improve questioning' — too broad. For example: 'After each worked example, pause and ask the student to predict what happens if one value changes. This turns passive watching into active reasoning and strengthens C2.'

Reference specific lesson moments

Where possible, give a timestamp, a specific question the tutor asked, a student response, or a specific board moment. 'The tutor explained well' tells the tutor nothing they can act on. 'At minute 23, the tutor skipped the substitution step and the student's confusion was visible from that point' is evidence.

7. JTD04 Form — Structure and Quality Expectations

The JTD04 Google Form is the formal record of every observation. It must be completed on the day of the observation or the following day at the latest.

#	Section	Fields	Quality Expectation
1	Lesson Context	Mentor name, tutor name, date, subject, year group, lesson topic, duration, lesson role	Complete and accurate. Lesson role must match where the tutor actually is in the residency pathway.
2	4T Rating	Rate each of the four 4T phases on a 1–5 scale.	Ratings must be justifiable from lesson evidence. A 4 or 5 should correspond to specific observed behaviours, not general positive impression.
3	JCT1 Ratings	Rate all 7 JCT1 competencies on a 1–5 scale, or mark N/O (not observable in this lesson).	Completed for every observation. N/O is acceptable where the lesson did not provide an opportunity — but use it sparingly and honestly.
4	Focus Competency	Name the primary competency focus for this observation. The competency selected must match the tutor's current residency stage. Rate 1–5. Provide specific lesson evidence.	One competency per observation. In Co-Teaching, this should be JCT1 only. In Lead Teaching and Independent Teaching, the competency focus should reflect the stage expectations set out in Section 5. Evidence must be a specific lesson moment — not a general comment.
5	Mentor Evaluation	Overall confidence 1–5. Sign-off eligible (Yes/Not yet). One improvement target.	Improvement target must be specific and actionable in the next lesson. 'Keep improving' is not a target.
6	Sign-Off Note	If sign-off appropriate: name the competency code and provide the supporting evidence note.	Only complete if the evidence genuinely supports sign-off. A 3/5 confidence rating should not trigger a sign-off entry.

8. Evidence Quality — What Counts

Counts as Evidence	Does Not Count as Evidence
A specific question the tutor asked and what it revealed	'The tutor asked good questions'
The moment a misconception was identified and how it was corrected	'The tutor handled errors well'
A Zoom recording timestamp linking to a specific teaching moment	'The lesson was strong overall'
How board work supported the explanation of a specific step	'Board work was clear'
The tutor's specific response when a student made an error	'The tutor corrected mistakes effectively'
Tutor self-report on the reflection form (supporting context only)	Tutor self-report as primary sign-off evidence

9. Common Observation Errors

Error	Why It Damages Development
Vague positive feedback	The tutor cannot act on 'great lesson'. It tells them nothing about what to repeat or change.
Too many improvement targets	Three or more targets scatter the tutor's attention. One target per lesson is the rule — make it the most important one.
Signing off after one strong lesson	One lesson proves a moment. Sign-off requires pattern. Wait for consistency across at least two lessons for the same competency.
Commenting on style rather than teaching effect	'I prefer a different explanation approach' is personal preference. The question is whether the student understood.
Rescuing the tutor too quickly	When the tutor struggles, resist the instinct to step in. A tutor who works through difficulty learns more than one who is rescued from it.
Completing the form days after the lesson	Lesson detail fades quickly. A form completed three days later is a reconstruction, not an observation record.
Using observation as performance management	Observation is a development tool. If it feels like an assessment the tutor must pass, the relationship breaks down and reflections stop being honest.

10. Version Notes — Changes from v1.0

Change	Reason
Three observation purposes defined	v1.0 described observation without distinguishing developmental, evidence-collection, and calibration purposes. v2.0 makes the distinction operational.

Change	Reason
4T observation table with strong/weak practice columns	v1.0 described the 4T lens in prose. v2.0 gives a reference table usable during the lesson itself.
Competency focus by stage table	v1.0 did not specify which competency levels apply at which stage. v2.0 aligns this with the residency pathway in JTD03 v2.0.
Form structure with quality expectations per section	v1.0 described form fields without stating what quality looks like. v2.0 adds quality expectations per section.
Evidence quality table added	New in v2.0. Direct contrast between evidence that counts and phrases that do not.
Competency references updated to A-F codes	All references now use the A-F taxonomy from JTD01 v2.0, consistent across all JTA documents.

Jothi Learning — United Kingdom

Operational note: Mentor and tutor dropdown options in the JTD04 Google Form must be updated at the start of each annual cohort. See the Forms and Dashboard Build Specification for the full update procedure.

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